



Land speed record

The current land speed record achieved by Andy Green of ThrustSSC stands at 1227.986 km/h

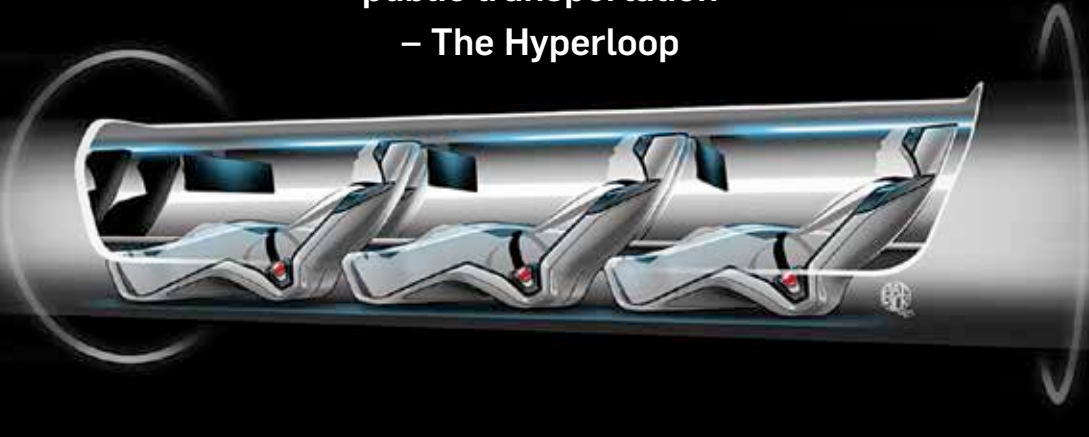


PS4 launch titles

Launch titles list for the PS4 has been revealed finally. Take a look: <http://dgit.in/16TAH8o>

The Usain Bolt of bullet trains

Elon Musk, the man behind Tesla Motors, PayPal, SpaceX and SolarCity has envisioned the next generation of high-speed public transportation – The Hyperloop



Mithun Mohandas
readersletters@thinkdigidit.com

Rail transportation is already pretty fast, the fastest bullet train travels at 300 km/h but that doesn't seem to be enough for Elon Musk so he has proposed the Hyperloop, a transport system where you have pods which travel at really high speeds through low pressure tubes. While there have been several proposals regarding similar vactrain technologies in the past, this one seems to have worked on the shortcomings of the older ideas while coming up short on a few points.

With Elon Musk the entrepreneurial attitude set in at an early of 12 when he designed a computer game and sold it for \$500, then sold an online service - Zip2 for over \$300 million. The next thing he helped co-found was Paypal which was bought out by eBay for \$1.5 billion. The figures have kept on rising ever since. The guy has been likened to Tony Stark in the media. He is smart, entrepreneurial, charitable and one of the fastest money making machines in the world. His green energy venture – SolarCity is currently the fastest growing company in the solar energy sector. SpaceX, the space transport company has already been con-

tracted by NASA to supply the International Space Station having conducted its first docking with the ISS in May 2012. Some might wonder that he is just a good CEO but it so turns out that he is the “Chief Designer” for the Falcon rockets and also the “Head of Product Design” at Tesla. The guy seems like King Midas high on caffeine or another Tony Stark.

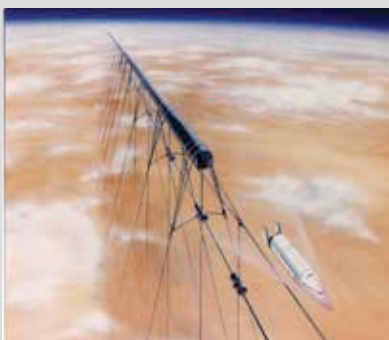
So why a Hyperloop?

Apart from being a real fast mode of transport, the Hyperloop is Elon Musk's answer to the overpriced “California High-speed Rail Project”, the hectic traffic and as a means to satisfy his set of criteria which are as follows:

- Safer
- Faster
- Lower cost
- More convenient
- Immune to weather
- Sustainably self - powering
- Resistant to Earthquakes
- Not disruptive to those along the route

The propulsion is provided using maglev technology but current maglev trains are open ended and not enclosed in a tube all throughout. This gives rise to the problem with air pressure and resist-

StarTram



The Hyperloop does seem a bit far-fetched but as you read into what all information Elon Musk has provided it starts to seem closer to reality. But as far as ambitious ideas go, the Hyperloop is small change compared to the StarTram – space launch platform.

That's right! It's a proposed system that would use maglev technology to propel a launch vehicle through a vacuum tube into space – 22 kilometers from the surface of the earth.